

Application sharing: With the application sharing capabilities of Windows Messenger, you can share control of an application with your contacts online. This is great for working together on a document with colleagues, for example.

Online status: You can let other users know if you are busy or on the phone, or have your status appear as offline in case you don't want anyone to disturb you but still see who is online.

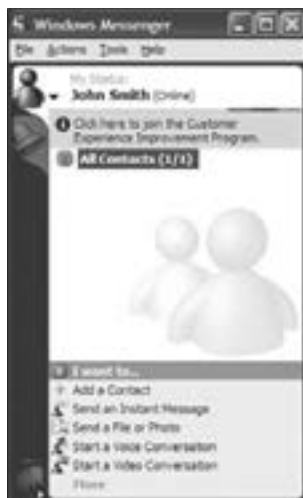
Remote assistance: With this feature, you can let a trusted friend or colleague control your computer over the Internet to troubleshoot problems or to teach you something new. If you are the expert, you can offer your help to your online buddies.

Block users: If there are people that you don't want to communicate with in real-time over the Web, Windows Messenger lets you block their access to you altogether.

Getting Started With Windows Messenger

Start Windows Messenger by double-clicking the Windows Messenger icon near the clock in the lower right corner of your screen, or by going to Start > Programs > Windows Messenger.

The first time you start Windows Messenger, you will be asked to sign in to the .NET Messenger service. The .Net Messenger Service window will ask for an e-mail address and password. The easiest way is to sign up for a free Hotmail account. If you do not have one of these accounts, click Get a .NET Passport in the lower left corner. You can get a new .NET Passport account by using any of your e-mail IDs—you do not neces-



You are now online!